

Prototype Project 2: Paper Prototype

ITIS 4350

Team 1

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Introduction:

This project is for developing a prototype interface design for an online auction/bidding website for college textbooks. This application prototype focuses on different tasks that users can complete and has four main user tasks.

The application tasks being prototyped are:

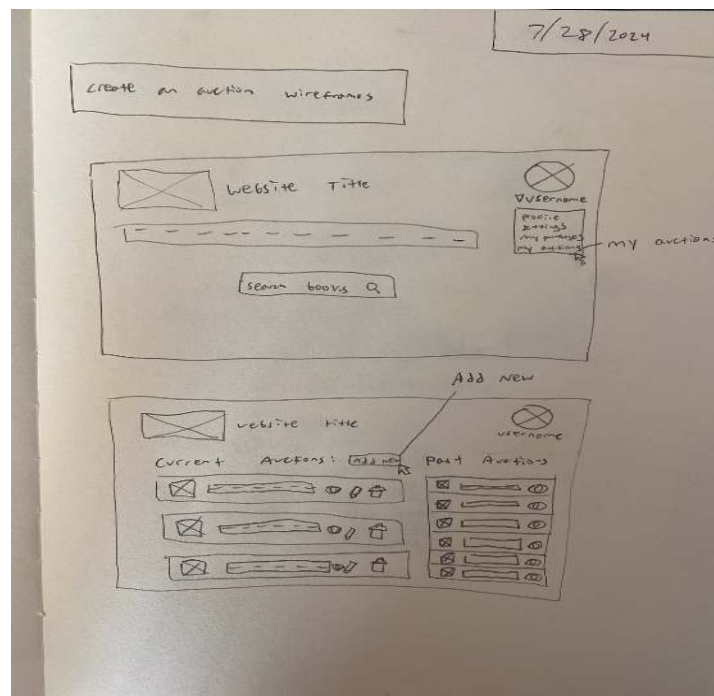
1. Create an auction - users can see their current/past auctions. They can also add a new item to auction which includes item details, type of auction, minimum bid, date limitations, etc. and a confirmation of auction creation.
2. Bid on an item - users can search for an item, select it, place a bid, and then confirm the bid for that item.
3. Review and rate the seller - users can provide feedback on the seller they purchased from. This includes reviewing certain topics and providing a star rating.
- 4.

Part 1: Prototype Development

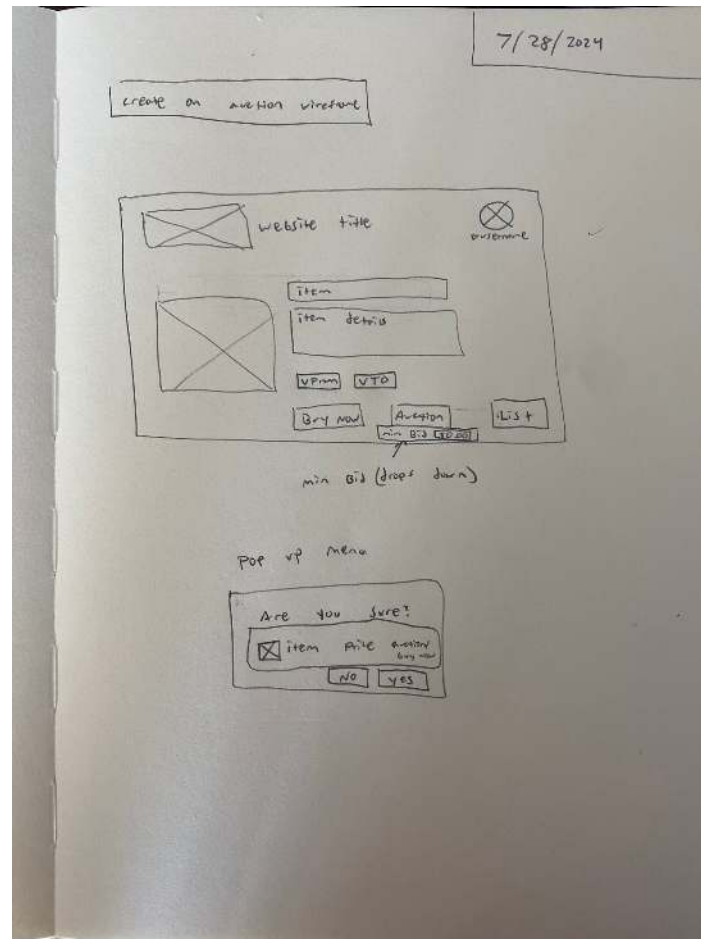
Task 1 - Create an Auction

Create an auction wireframes 7/28/2024

my auctions, Add New



min bid (drops down), Pop Up Menu



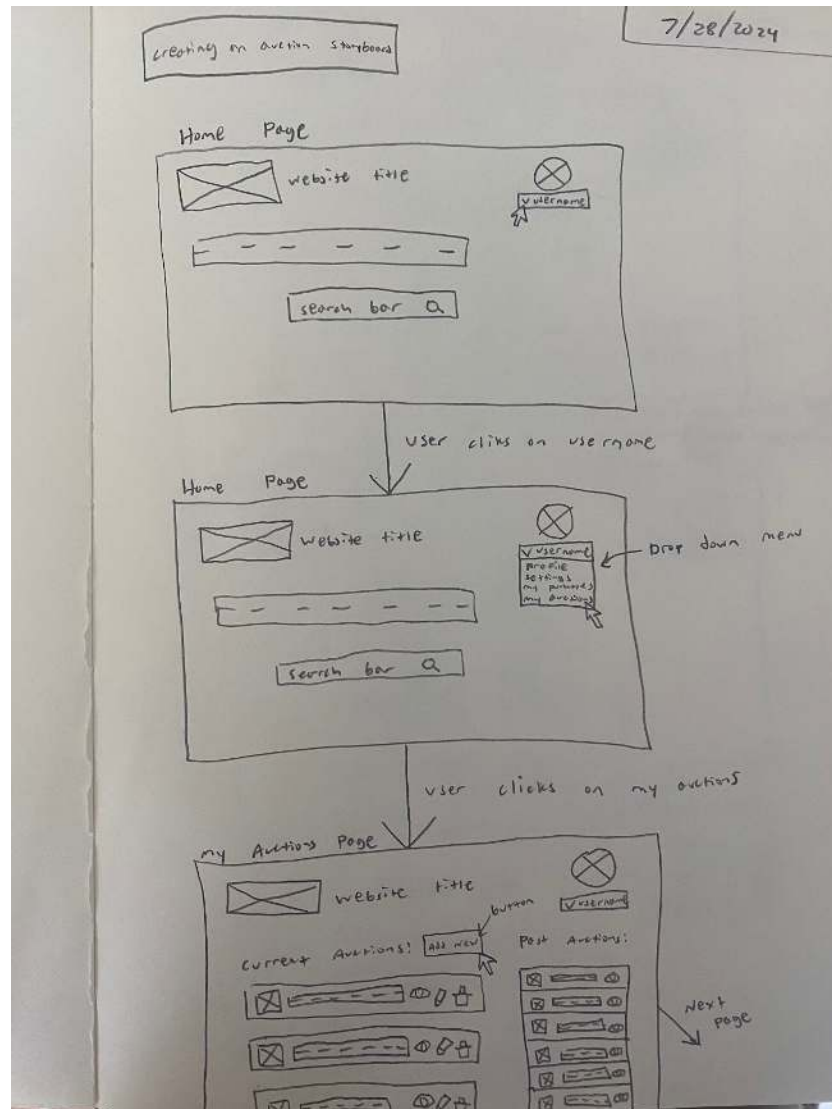
Create an auction sequential storyboard

Home page.

1. User clicks on username
2. User clicks on my auctions from the drop down menu

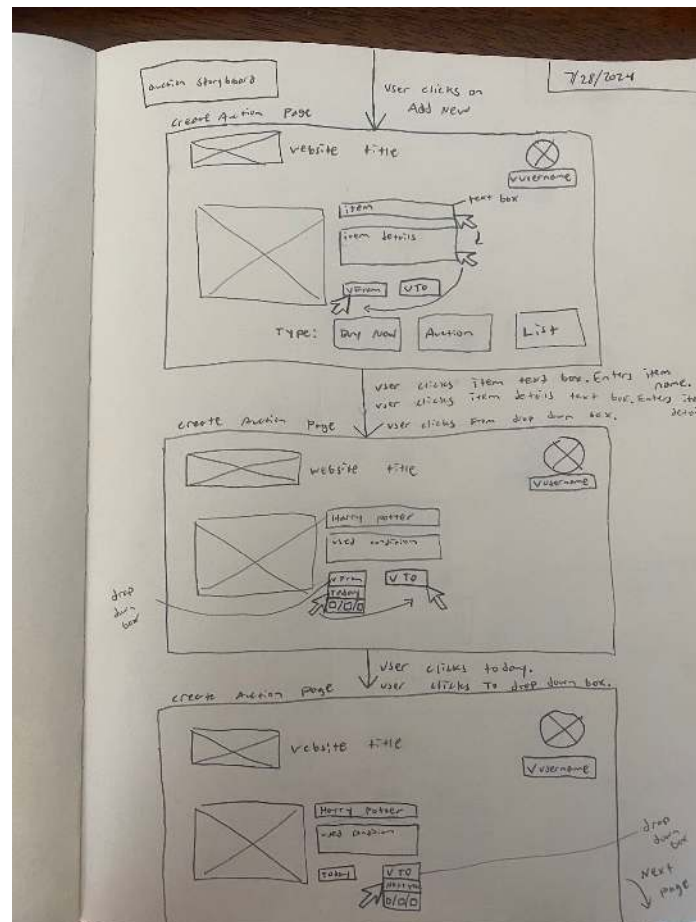
My auctions page

3. User clicks on Add New button.

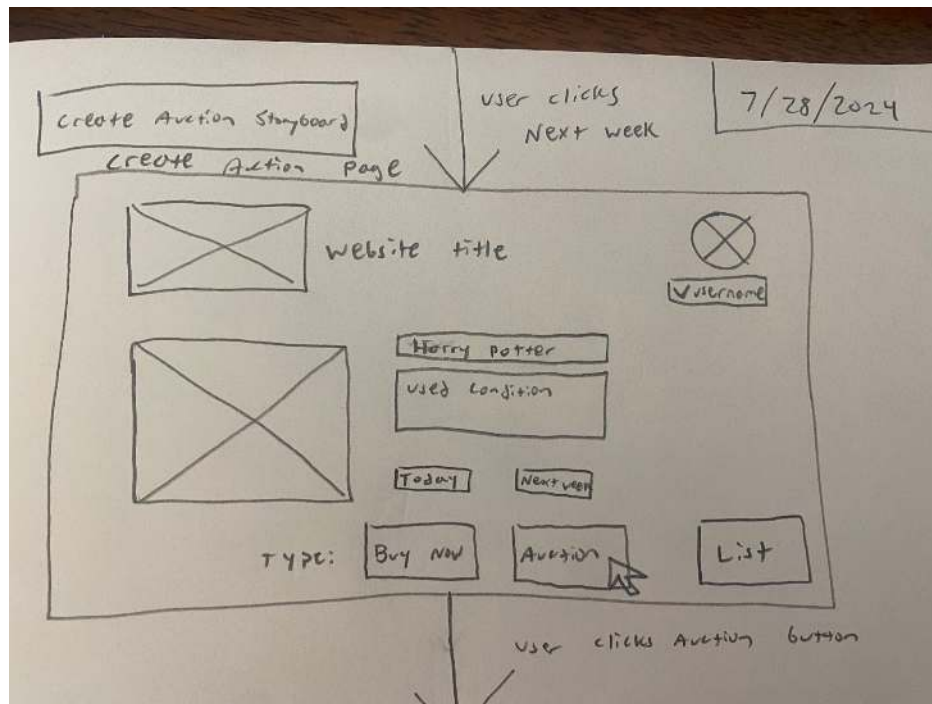


Create Auction Page

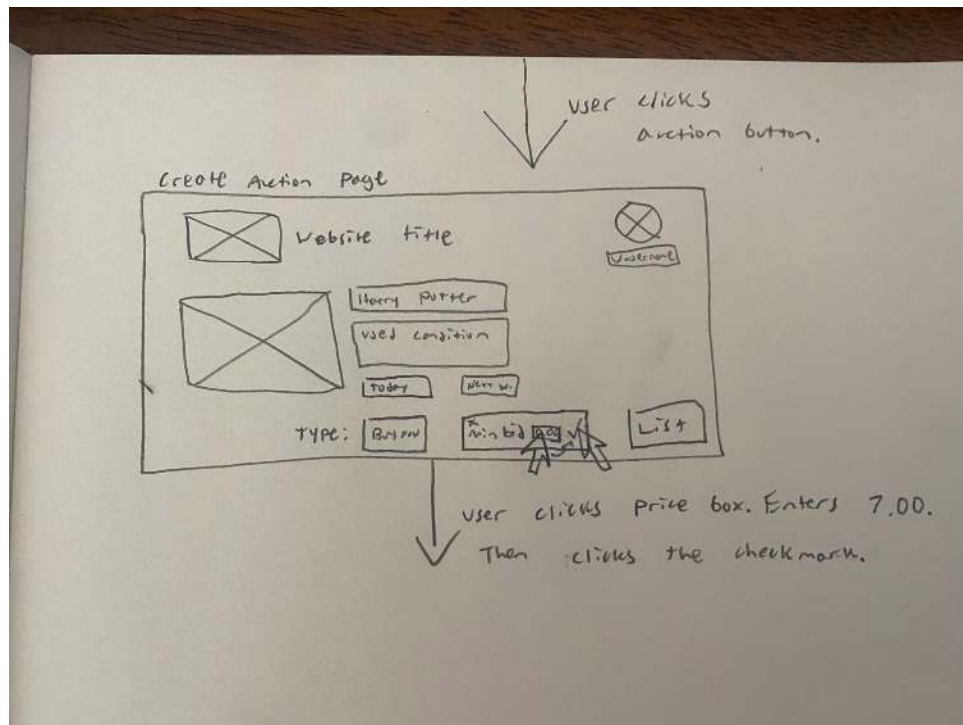
4. User clicks item text box. Enters item name. User clicks item details text box. Enters item details. User clicks the "From" drop down box.
5. User clicks today. User clicks the "To" drop down box.



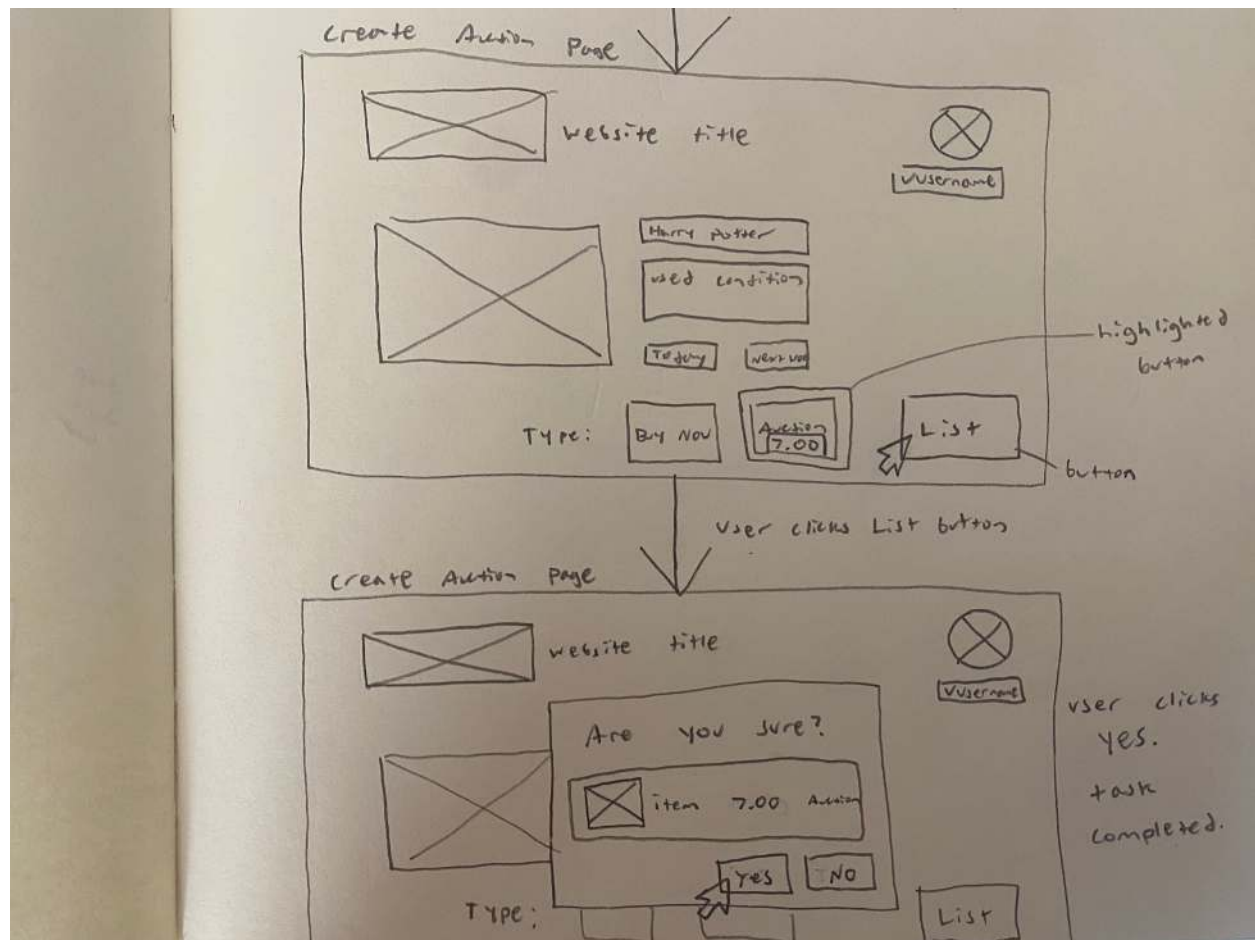
6. User clicks next week.



7. User clicks Auction button



8. User clicks price box. Enters 7.00. Then clicks the check mark.
9. User clicks list button
10. User clicks yes. Task completed



Video Prototype

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/17Lspv-qJ2mLTk1Zcjr1dKvulXCE0jES/view?usp=drivesdk>

Task 2 - Bid on an item

Task Introduction

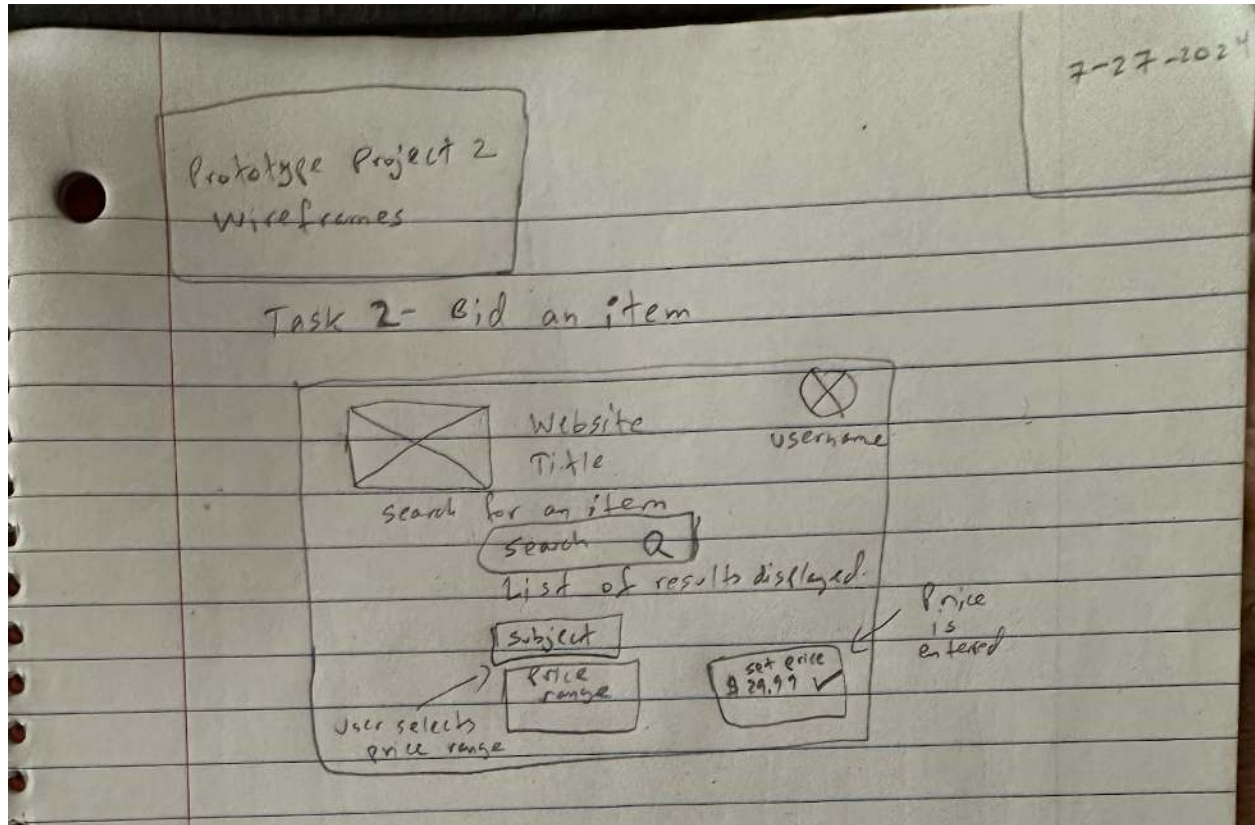
This task is being designed by Qudrat Siyal. This task allows the user to search for an item, select an item, place a bid on that item, and confirm the bid.

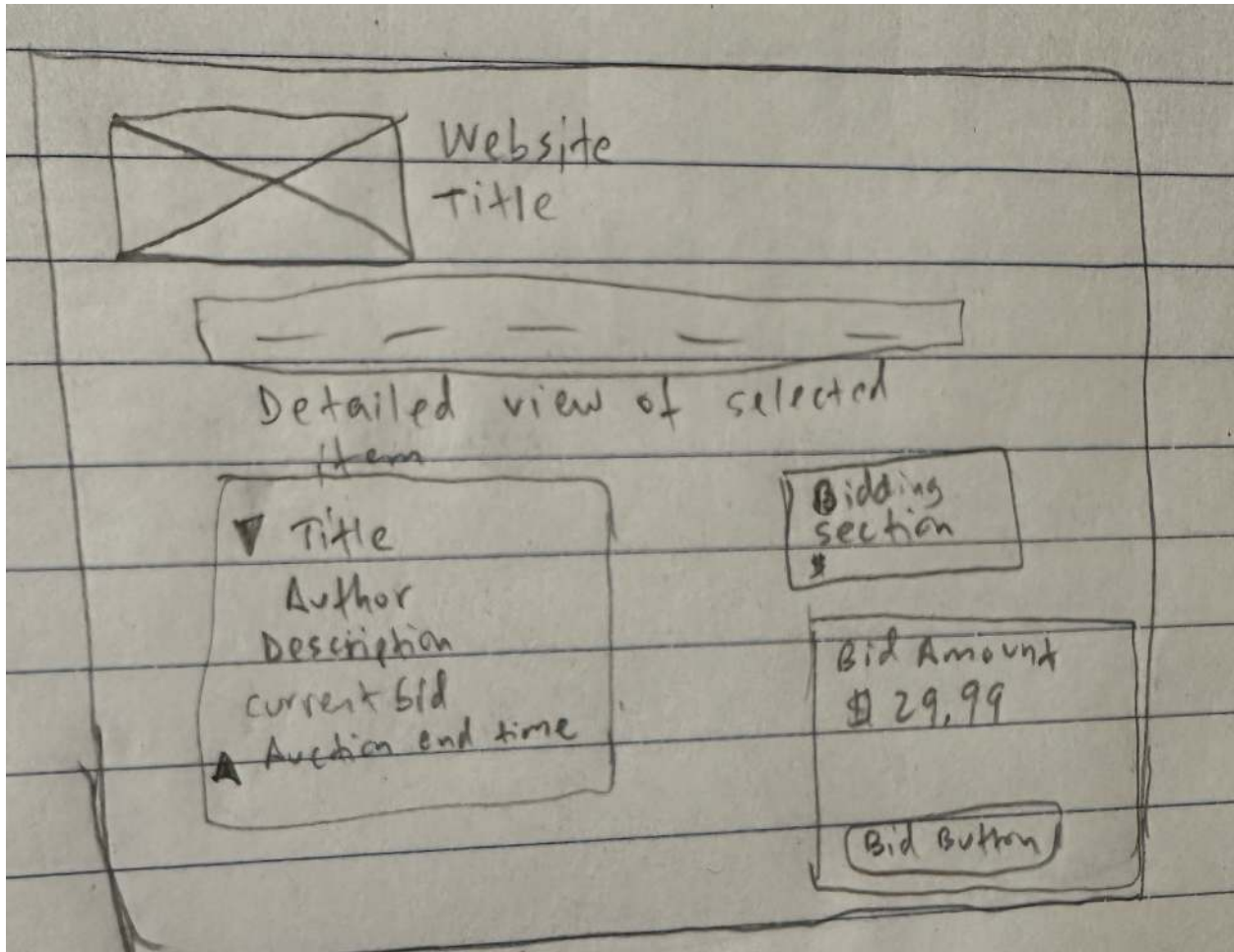
The main features of this task are:

- Search an item by typing in keywords
- Filter options to narrow down search results

- Display books
- Interactive Elements: Each search result should view details
- Bid Details such as confirm button

Sketchbook Wireframes





The sketch is a hand-drawn interface for a 'Confirmation Page' for a bid. It is enclosed in a rectangular border. At the top left is a rectangular box with an 'X' inside. To its right is the text 'Website Title'. At the top right is a circular icon with an 'X' inside, with the text 'Username' below it. Below these elements is a long, horizontal rectangular box containing five short horizontal lines. The main title 'Confirmation Page' is centered below this box, followed by the subtitle 'Details of bid placed'. On the left side, there is a square box with an 'X' inside, with the text 'item name' below it. To the right of this are three checkboxes, each followed by text: 'bid amount section', 'confirmation button', and 'Auction End time'. At the bottom center is a rounded rectangular box containing the text 'Option to cancel Bid'.

Website Title

Username

Confirmation Page

Details of bid placed

item name

- ☐ bid amount section
- ☐ confirmation button
- ☐ Auction End time

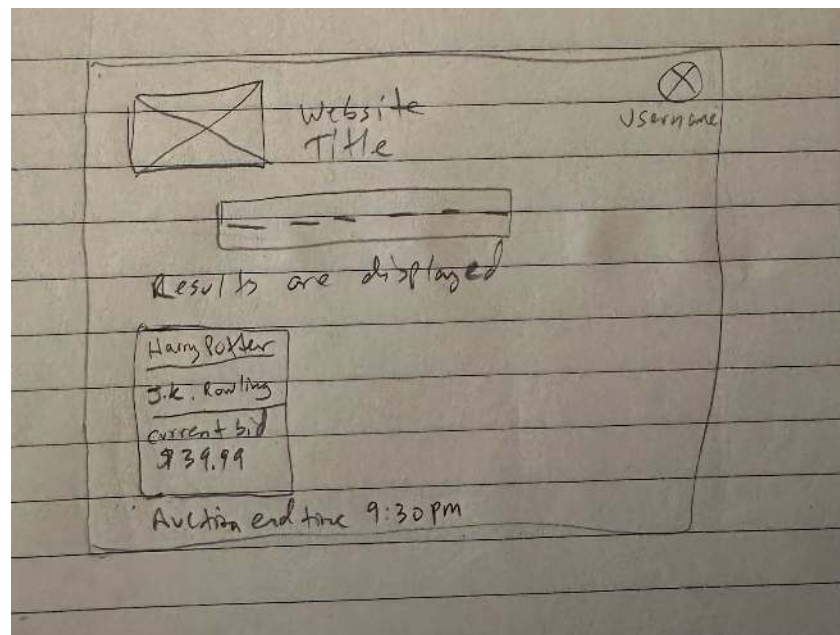
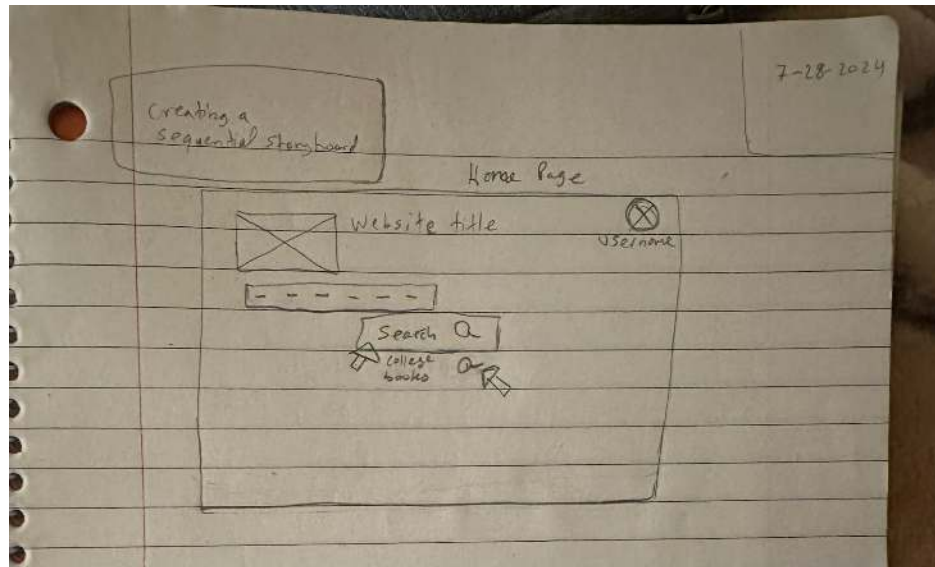
Option to cancel Bid

Create a sequential storyboard

Step 1: user types in the search bar

Step 2: Users clicks on the search button

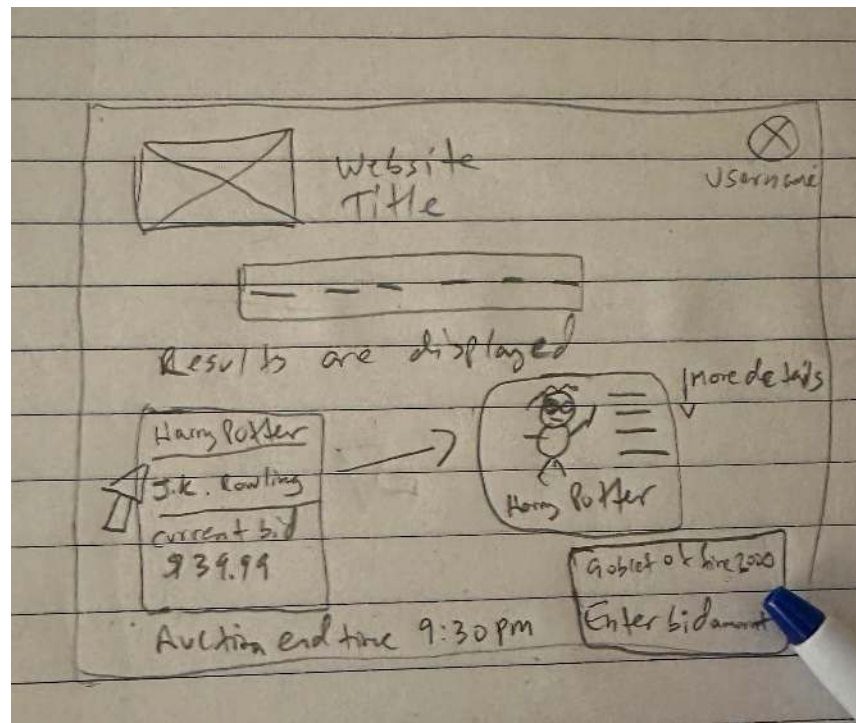
Step 3: Search results are displayed



Step 4: User clicks on a specific book

Step 5: A detailed view of the book is shown

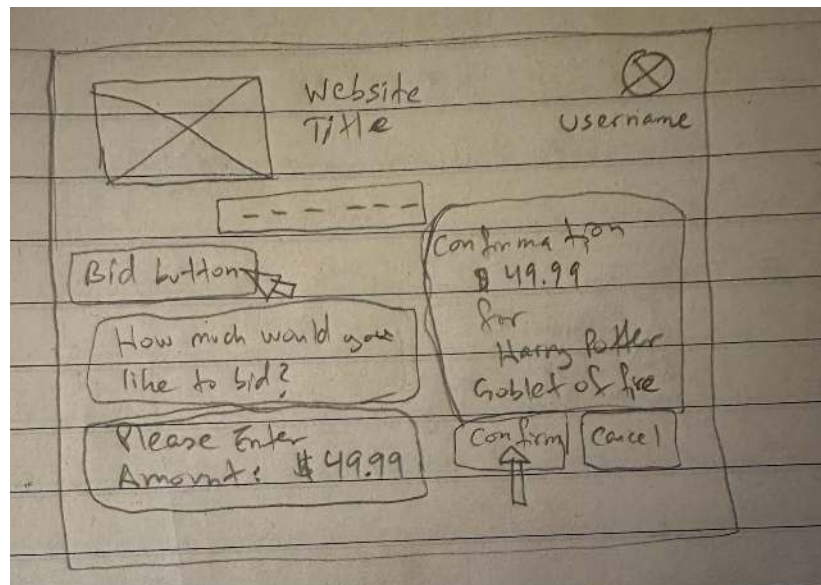
Step 6: User enters bid amount



Step 7: User clicks on bid button

Step 8: Confirmation message is displayed

Step 9: User confirms the bid



Video Demonstration:

<https://drive.google.com/file/d/1HEdKoFDcRakplkvN8EOsfzVIMaUTgwz/view?usp=sharing>

Interactive Elements:

1. Search bar: It is used for text input.
2. Dropdowns: These are foldable elements such as checkboxes and buttons.
3. Bid input field: It is used to enter bid amounts.
4. Bid button: It is a clickable button for placing bids.
5. Confirmation Modal: It shows confirmation options and bid details.

Design Patterns:

1. Visual Framework: Each wireframe uses a consistent layout with a logo in the top left corner. It also includes the user profile on the right side of the page and there is a drop-down menu underneath the profile picture.
2. Drop-Down menus: the dropdown menu can be expanded and collapsed.
3. Search Pattern: The search bar is included with filters that allows users to narrow down search results based on specific criteria.
4. Input Pattern: An input field is there for entering bid amounts with a place bid button.
5. Visual Hierarchy: The interface design maintains a clear visual hierarchy with prominent placement of important elements like the search bar, bid input field, and confirmation portion.

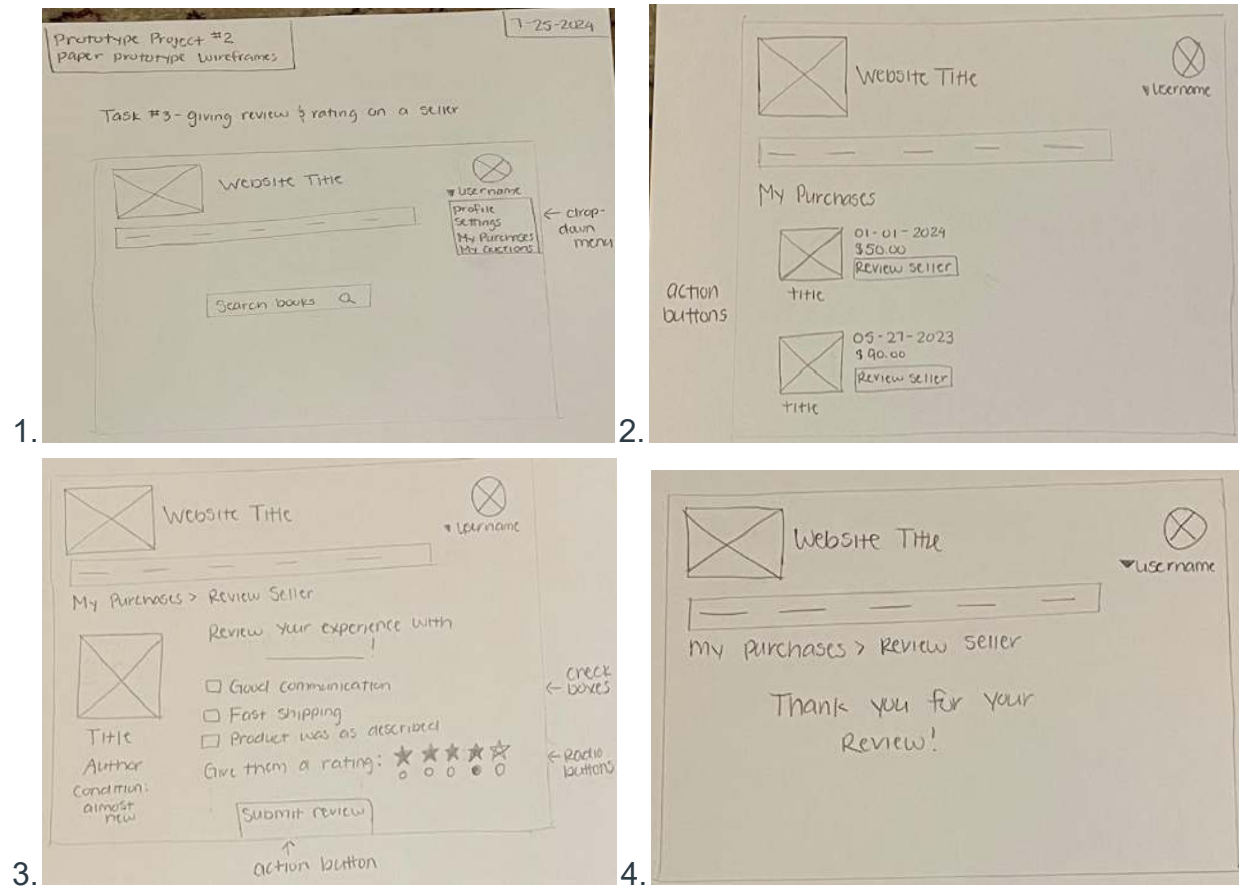
Task 3 - Review a seller you purchased from

Task Introduction

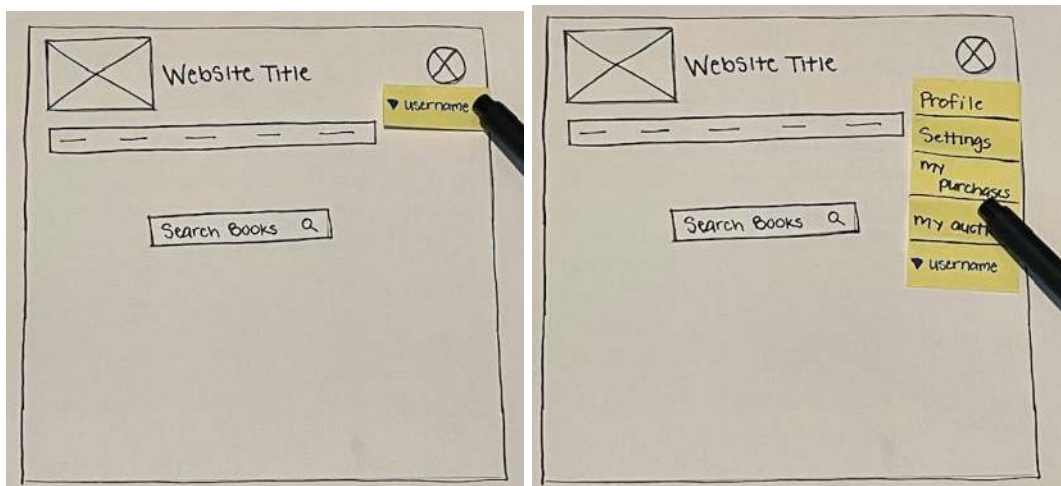
This task is being designed by Ayisha Riaz. This task focuses on writing a review and giving the seller a rating from which the user purchased from. The main features to complete this task are:

- Finding the “My purchases” tab in the drop-down menu.
- Selecting an item from their past purchases.
- Checking (or not checking) review phrases that describe their experience.
- Providing a star rating from 1-5 on the experience.
- Submitting both the review and rating.

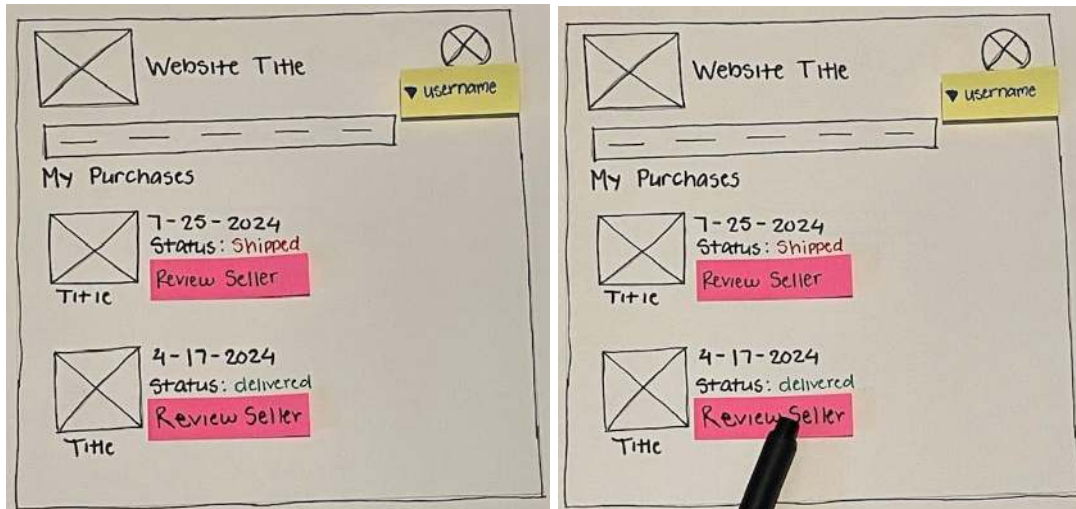
Sketchbook Wireframes



Paper Prototype: Sequential Storyboard

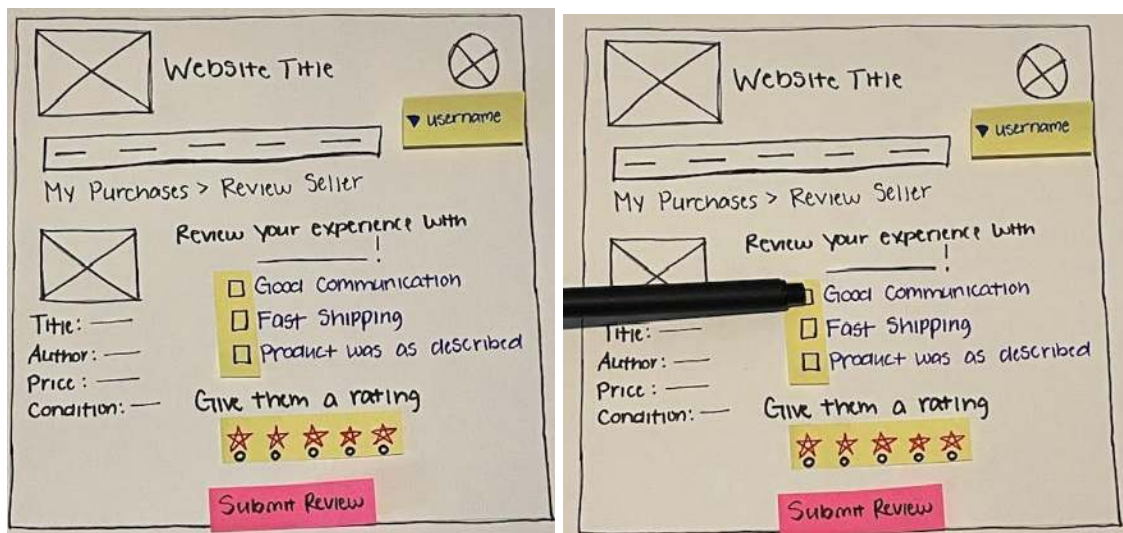


1. From the homepage, the user clicks on the drop-down menu to expand it.
2. The user clicks on "My Purchases" to view their history of purchases.



3. The user sees their past purchases.

4. User clicks on “Review Seller” for the purchase they want to review.



5. The user is brought to the “Review Seller” screen which shows detailed information about the book they purchased and the form to submit a review.

6. User checks the box for “Good Communication”.

The image shows two sequential hand-drawn paper prototypes of a web form for reviewing a seller. Both prototypes have a header with a placeholder for a website title, a user profile picture, and a dropdown menu for the username. The main heading is 'My Purchases > Review Seller'. Below this is a sub-heading 'Review your experience with' followed by a placeholder for the seller's name. There are three checkboxes: 'Good Communication' (checked), 'Fast Shipping' (unchecked), and 'Product was as described' (checked). Below the checkboxes are input fields for 'Title:', 'Author:', 'Price:', and 'Condition:'. A five-star rating system is shown with the fourth star selected. A pink 'Submit Review' button is at the bottom. A black pen is shown interacting with the form in both prototypes.

7. User checks the box for “Product was as described”.

8. User clicks on the radio button to give a star rating to the seller.

The image shows two sequential hand-drawn paper prototypes of a confirmation screen. The left prototype shows the same form as before, but with the 'Submit Review' button highlighted. The right prototype shows a confirmation message: 'Thank You! Your feedback has been received.' The input fields for 'Title:', 'Author:', 'Price:', and 'Condition:' are now empty. A black pen is shown clicking the 'Submit Review' button in the left prototype.

9. User clicks on “Submit Review” to finalize the submission.

10. There is a confirmation screen so the user knows the form was successful.

Paper Prototype: Video Demonstration

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1V-gC7zIU4oFkCUp9nUtTe0Cj7fz32v_h/view?usp=drive_link

Interactive Elements:

- Drop-down menu - The task begins by expanding a drop-down menu that is present on the home page (and every screen) under the user's profile picture.

This menu expands to show the user's personal menu such as profile, settings, their purchases, and their auctions.

- Action buttons - There are two action buttons for this task: "Review Seller" and "Submit Review". These buttons take the user to the next page in the sequence to continue the task (Review Seller) or to show them the task has been successfully completed (Submit Review).
- Check boxes - When the user is filling out their review, they can check or uncheck the boxes next to common review phrases that apply to their experience with the seller. This makes the review process easier than them having to type out a review entirely and instead gives them suggestions on what to review the seller on.
- Radio buttons - The star rating feature is made up of radio button elements. The user can make one selection to indicate the number of stars they would like to give the seller and those number of stars will be colored in to show the user their selection.

Design Patterns:

- Visual Framework - Each wireframe uses a consistent layout with a logo in the top left corner, a navigation menu underneath it, the user profile on the right side of the page, and a drop-down menu underneath their profile picture.
- Drop-down menus - the dropdown menu underneath the user profile can be expanded and collapsed. This is a great way to keep the menu information organized and the webpage less cluttered.
- Breadcrumbs - This task incorporates breadcrumbs to show the user how far into the "My Purchases" menu option they are.
- Visual Hierarchy - I attempted to keep the clarity of these wireframes by keeping a consistent layout, with the use of the breadcrumbs, and aligning my content in the same way on each page. In the video demonstration you can see that the layout transition is consistent between each page. The affordances such as the buttons, drop-down arrow, checkboxes, and radio buttons are also clear and clickable action items.

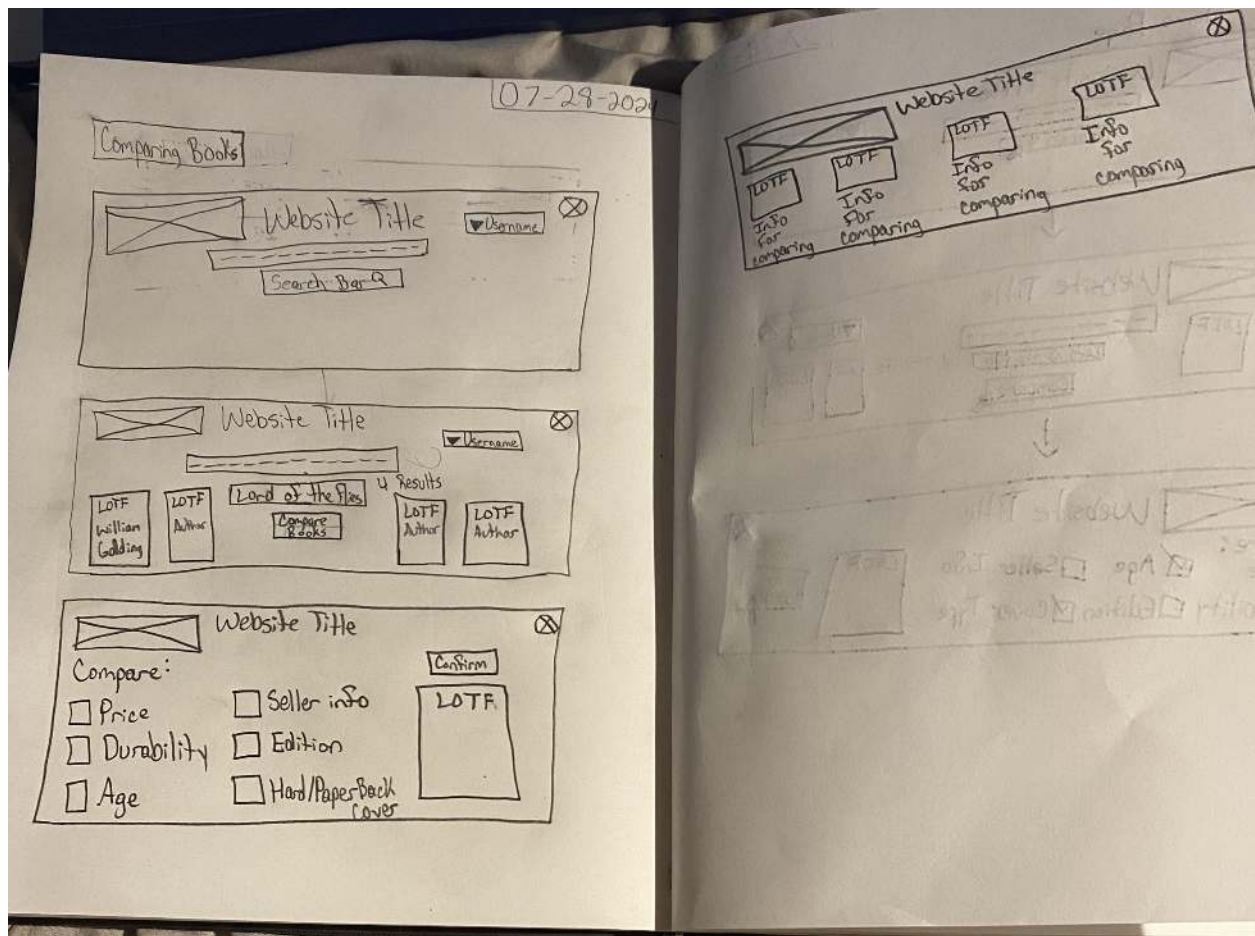
Task 4 - Comparing Offers

This task is designed by Chris Parker. This task allows the user to compare items and look for differences between offers from sellers.

The main features of this task are:

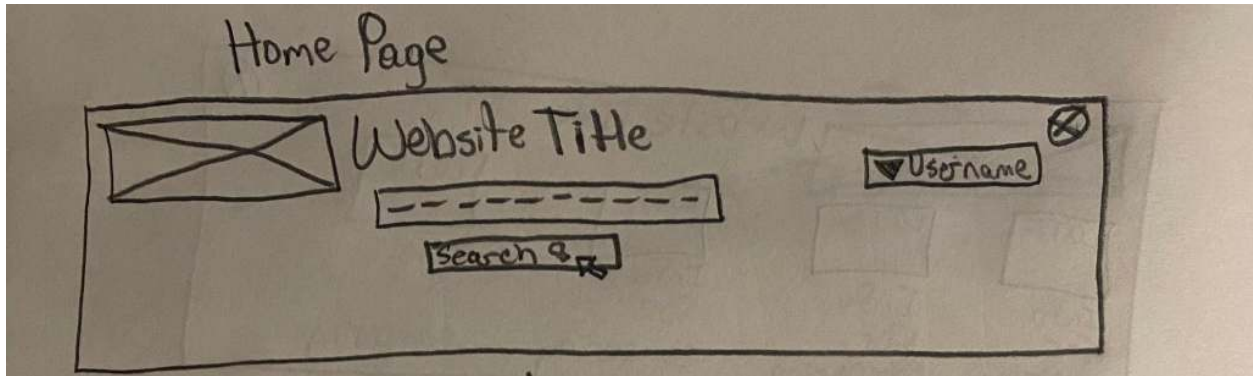
- Compare prices of books
- Look at book conditions
- Show buyer the seller's previous sales
- Show ratings

Sketch Wireframes



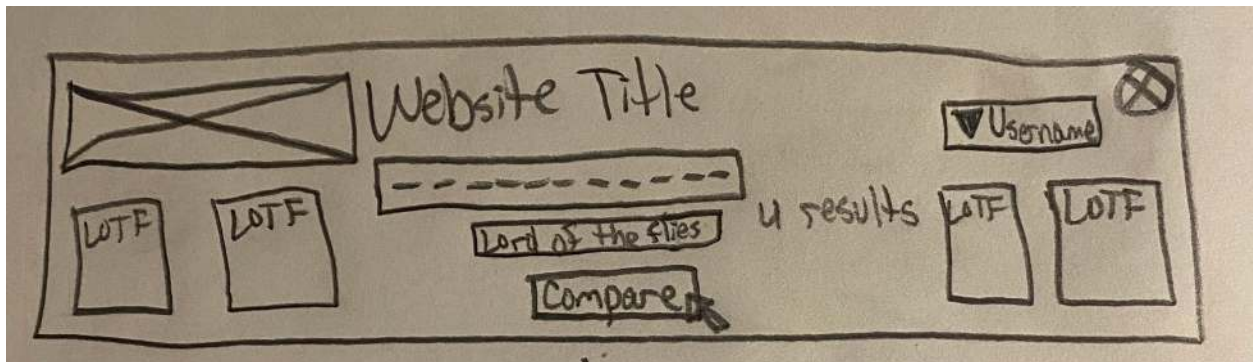
Sequential Storyboard:

1st Step: Starting on the Home Page, click on the search bar and search for your designated book.

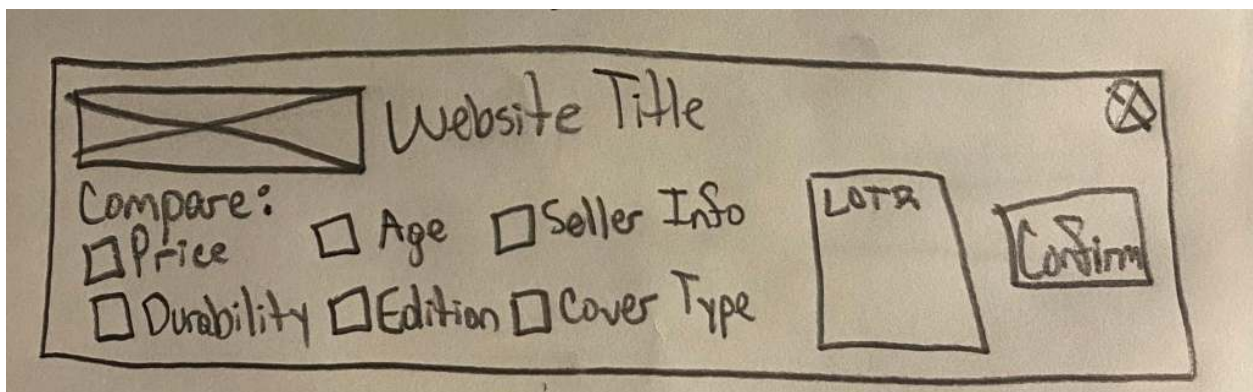


2nd Step: After searching, multiple options (4 results) appear for the user to select between.

3rd Step: Looking under the search bar and results, there will be a Compare button. The user will select the button to continue.



4th Step: After clicking on the Compare button, the page where you can compare different kinds of options for books.



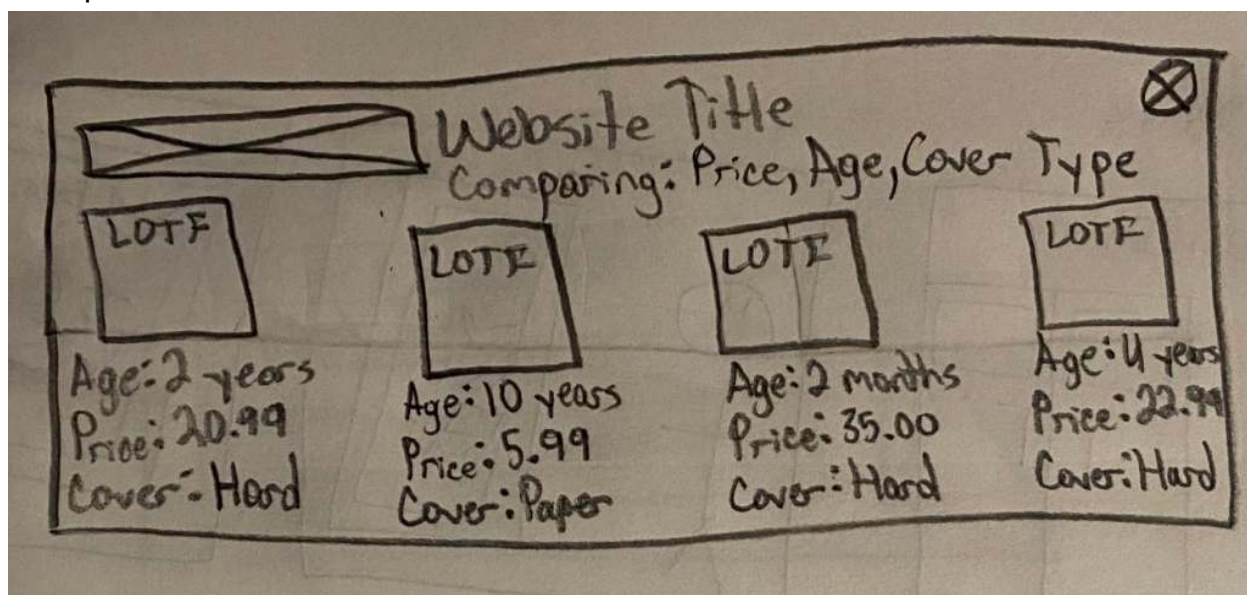
5th Step: The user will select the options they want to look for (Price/Current Bid Price, Age, Cover Type).

A hand-drawn sketch of a web form. At the top left is a rectangular box with an 'X' inside. To its right is the text 'Website Title'. In the top right corner is a small circle with an 'X' inside. Below the 'X' box, the word 'Compare:' is written. Under 'Compare:', there are three checked checkboxes: 'Price', 'Age', and 'Cover Type'. To the right of these are two unchecked checkboxes: 'Seller Info' and 'Edition'. Below 'Price' is an unchecked checkbox for 'Durability'. To the right of the checkboxes is a rectangular box labeled 'LOTR'. To the right of the 'LOTR' box is a rectangular button labeled 'Confirm'.

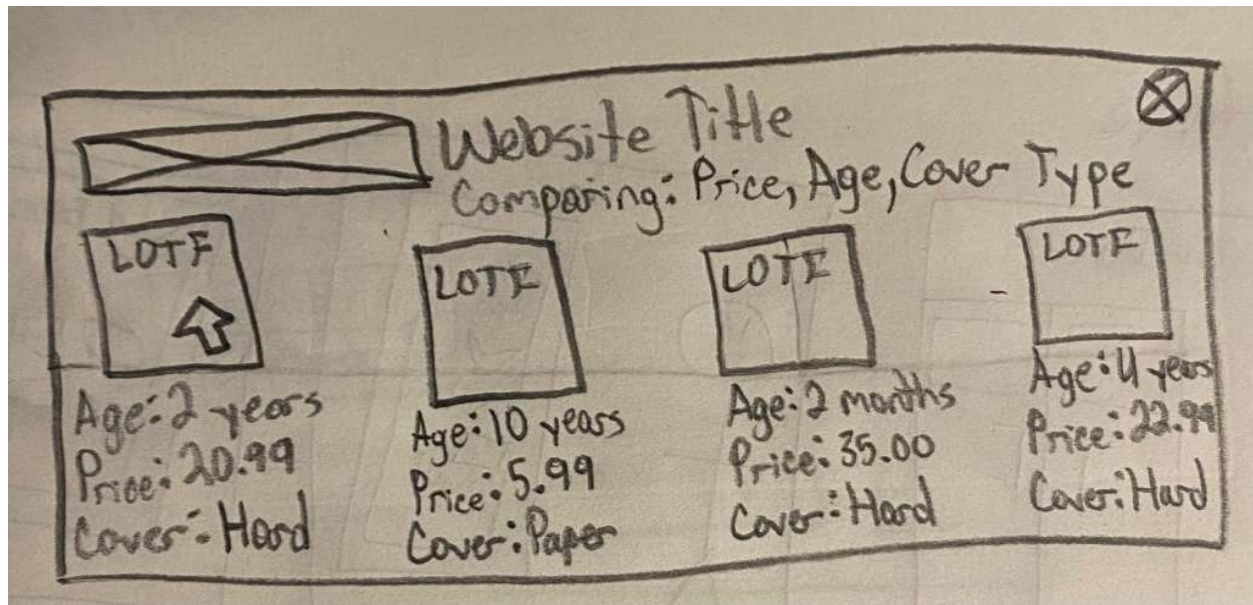
6th Step: The user will select the "Confirm" button after selecting their options for the book and continue onto the next page.

A hand-drawn sketch of a web form, identical to the one in the previous image. It shows the same layout: a box with an 'X', 'Website Title', a close button, 'Compare:' section with checked 'Price', 'Age', and 'Cover Type' options, unchecked 'Seller Info' and 'Edition' options, an unchecked 'Durability' option, a 'LOTR' box, and a 'Confirm' button. In this version, a small arrow points to the 'Confirm' button, indicating the user's selection.

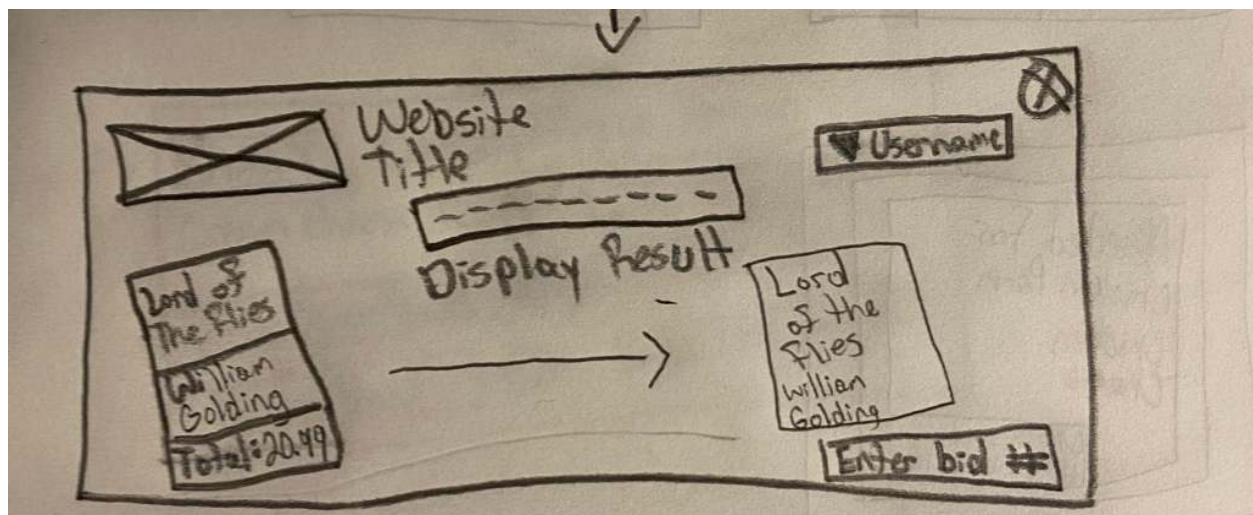
Final Step: The user will be directed to the page where they can see the specific information they wanted to see for each book and also show what options they chose at the top.



Extra Steps: This task can continue into another option by selecting the image above the info for a specific book and clicking on it.



Extra Steps: The bidding screen will be displayed with even more extra information displayed for the user to view.



Paper Prototype: Video Demonstration:

https://drive.google.com/file/d/1TrPF_LDFjIKzwWo3wyL0e0CLp--FIJGz/view?usp=drive_link

Interactive Elements:

1. Search bar: The task uses the search bar to search for a book that you want to bid for.
2. Compare/Confirm Button: The task uses a radio button with the word “Compare” after you search for your designated book. This allows you to compare the results of the books for further introspection. The “Confirm” button also confirms the choices you made and displays the results.
3. Comparison Checkboxes: The task uses checkboxes to allow the user to select what features they would like to compare the books between.

Design Patterns:

1. Visual Framework: Each wireframe uses a consistent layout with a logo in the top left corner. It also includes the user profile on the right side of the page and there is a drop-down menu underneath the profile picture.
2. Search Efficiency: The search bar allows the user to be able to narrow down what book they are looking for and the checkboxes allow for an even narrower search as the options cut down the results even more.
3. Confirmation Transparency: The buttons for confirmation and comparison are larger to provide clarity for the user to see where to progress next. That is also similar to how the checkboxes and search bar are as well.
4. Visual Hierarchy: The interface is similar across all webpages with the text on the page and elements being clear throughout the wireframe.

Part 2: Report Organization - Discussion / Sections

Task Coordination

- The home page and navigation bar are consistent throughout all the tasks. A lot of our pages use big buttons for completion of tasks or inputs. We have also included a user profile icon with the drop-down navigation in every wireframe as well as logo and website title placement.
- Tasks 1 and 3 are connected because they are both found in the drop-down navigation under the user’s profile as they are specific to each profile on our website so we decided to group them together in this menu.

Content-Fidelity Matrix

Content	Very-Low Fidelity	Low Fidelity	Medium Fidelity	High Fidelity	Very-High Fidelity
Information Design			X		
Interaction Design				X	
Visual/Branding Design	X				
Editorial Design				X	

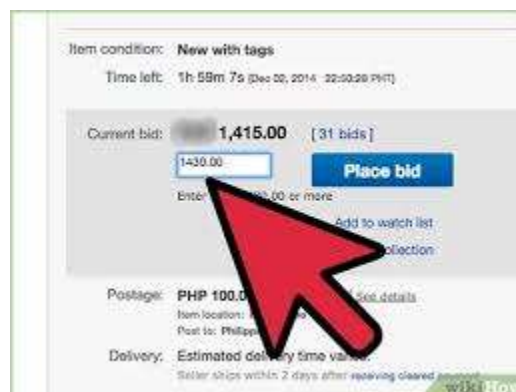
- Information Design: The content structure of our wireframes overall is between medium and high fidelity. We organized our navigation, headings, buttons, and labels to help facilitate task completion for users more consistently and intuitively. The navigation bar and drop-down menus in each wireframe contributed to this. All of our wireframes also include action buttons that afford users to click on them and familiarize them with the navigation style of the website. The structure of all of our wireframes is also consistent in that it has the logo, headings, and menus at the top of the page, and the content specific to the page underneath it. The reason we rated ourselves medium-high is because we did not explicitly label our navigation bar with headings, but instead used placeholders.
- Interaction Design: The interaction design is high fidelity because the sequential wireframes and video demonstrations show constant interaction between the user's choices and the prototype progressing to the next step of the task. The sequential wireframes show how the user can navigate through each screen, entering information via text entry, checking boxes or radio buttons, or pressing action buttons and links. Our wireframes also show the navigation between each screen and the response that the webpage will give after each action of the user. Furthermore, our video demonstrations have complete narration that complement the interaction choices of the user.
- Visual/Branding Design: Our wireframes exhibit extremely low fidelity this time. We have an overall consistent layout of our content with the logos, headings, and navigation in the same areas. We also used consistent placeholders for our images, icons, and headings. However, there is no consistency between typography, fonts, or color scheme as we each created our own individual paper prototypes with the supplies that we had for each task.

- Editorial Design: The editorial design of our wireframes is high fidelity. We used very little placeholder text except for the navigation bar and website title. For each task, we clearly labeled our headings and interactive elements. We even added example editorial content such as names of textbooks, prices, and dates. We did not include any actual images and instead just used placeholders for those.

Inspirations Discussions

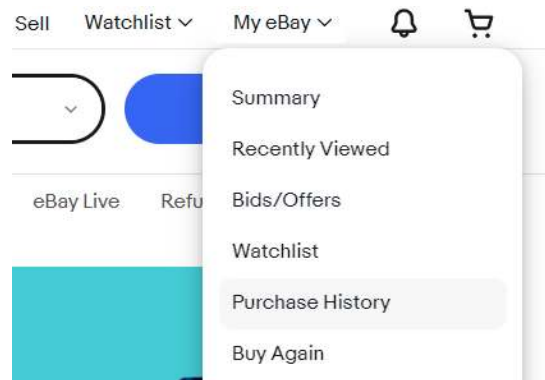


Task 1: I used inspiration from Ebay since it maintains a consistent visual layout throughout its auction creation process. The interface features a clean design with clearly labeled sections, which helps users understand each step of the process. One of the website's strengths is its comprehensive item detail section. Sellers can provide extensive information about the item, including title, description, category, condition, and photos.

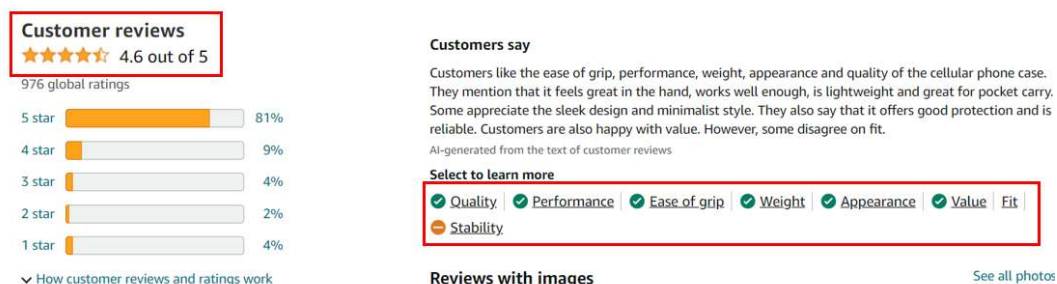


Task 2: I took inspiration from Ebay because it is straightforward. Users can enter their bid amount in a designated input field and click the place bid button. The system also shows the current highest bid and the minimum bid increment. eBay keeps users

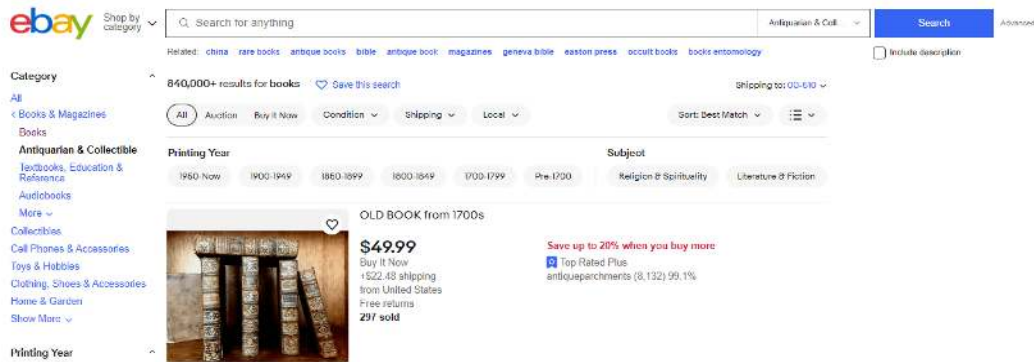
informed about the status of their bids through notifications. Users can search results for different categories such as price ranges and item conditions.



Task 3: Since Ebay was provided as a reference for this project, I used inspiration from the website. I thought it was intuitive to have a personalized drop-down menu for the user that included things like their purchase history. I used this to connect the purchase history to Task 3: Giving the seller a review.



Task 3: I also decided to take inspiration from Amazon. I wanted to incorporate a star rating system and I modified my design to be interactive with radio buttons. I also wanted to simplify the review process and make it more interactive and user-friendly. Rather than just providing a text box where a user types in a review, I provided them with common review phrases that they could check or uncheck, similar to how you can in an Amazon review.



Task 4: This image, while not exactly like how I wanted it to look, inspired how I did the comparison section. It shows basic information about the bidder and their book and it also has the search bar and all. I added the checkboxes as that allows for a more narrow search and improves functionality with searching for the right book.

Overall Team Project Reflection/Critique

Task 1: The things that work well for the interface designs for task 1 is that it creates realistic visuals of what a bidding website usually looks like. The large buttons are readable and help guide the user through the task. The drop down menus are clearly labeled and understood. All directions for the task are fulfilled (users can see their current/past auctions. They can also add a new item to auction which includes item details, type of auction, minimum bid, date limitations, etc. and a confirmation of auction creation) Finally, the inclusion of areas that did not involve the task create a wireframe that is realistic to the scenario of an auction website, as mentioned earlier will help users work through the task more efficiently. An area for improvement could be to clearly state the auction type of either a bid or buy now. This area of the video prototype was a little confusing when working through the task.

Task 2: The design for task 2, effectively guides the user through the entire bidding process. The search functionality is intuitive which allows the user to easily find specific college books using keywords and filters. The detailed view of the selected item is comprehensive, providing users with all the necessary information about the book, such as title, author, description, current bid, auction end time, and images. One area for improvement is the clarity of the bidding increments since it might be beneficial to provide additional examples to help users understand how much they should increase their bid by. A brief explanation of what would happen if a bid was confirmed could have been there so users could feel more confident about their actions.

Task 3: Task 3 allows users to review their experience of purchasing from a seller. Accessing this task from the personalized drop-down menu of the user will allow

them to find it easier because they will be able to understand that their purchases would be under their own username rather than on a public space on the rest of the website. Viewing their purchase history will remind them of their past purchases as well as the status of their orders before they review their experience. The use of breadcrumbs in this task helps guide the user so they know what task they are completing as they're doing it and can help them navigate away if they are in the wrong area. The actual "Review Seller" page could be improved in some ways. They could be presented with more phrases to check/uncheck to accommodate more areas for reviewing such as "Lowest price guaranteed", "Good customer service", etc. There should also be an additional optional text entry box where the user can type in any comments that they didn't see a pre-made checkbox for, or to explain why they gave the seller a particular star rating. This would enhance the experience for both the user and the seller. Lastly, I attempted to create the layout of the "Review Seller" wireframe in a grid, but I think it could be improved by making the grid structure more rigid or by utilizing cards.

Task 4: This task implements a comparison option for users to compare books based on certain options such as price, age, and cover type. The images appear above the search to give the user a vision of what they will be bidding for. This helps minimize the amount of time looking for the right book that the user wants. The search bar causes the search to narrow while the checkbox allows the search to narrow even further. Also with the addition of being able to traverse from the comparison page to the bidding page allows the users to have a well rounded experience with the website.

Overall Reflection: For the application as a whole, we feel that we were much more consistent with our individual prototypes this time around. Each of us focused on the needs that college books might have on an auction website and prioritized those details when designing our tasks for them. We were much more consistent with the visual framework of our wireframes. The information design, interaction design features, and editorial design were also more consistent this time than in our last project. We prioritized using the same page structure across the wireframes which included logos, headings, navigation bars, the drop-down menu, and the user profile. Though our coordination has improved, we can still work on several aspects such as the visual branding design to enhance our wireframes with the use of colors and real images/icons instead of placeholders. Another way to improve our design would be to have more connections between tasks. Currently, only tasks 1 and 3 are sort of connected by being located in the same drop-down menu. It could enhance the user experience to include a search bar on every page of the website to incorporate task 2, bidding on an item (after searching for it). This would prevent the user from having to start over on the home page and they could start this task from any page. Task 4 incorporates the usage of checkboxes and radio buttons to narrow options down and improve user experience. It

also links task 4 to task 2 and shows how the website pages connect to one another. By allowing users to compare prices, book conditions, seller histories, and ratings, task 4 ensures that users have all the necessary information to make informed decisions. We prioritized using the same page structure across the wireframes, which included logos, headings, navigation bars, the drop-down menu, and the user profile. Some improvements we can make are adding visual branding design to enhance our wireframes with the use of colors and real images/icons instead of placeholders.